world will wonder: if Indians can buy a four-door car for $2,500, why can't they?'

Sumantran attests to the extraordinary attention that the Nano attracted even in the most reputed global design institutions. He had attended a meeting at Art Center College of Design after the Nano's launch. There he could find hardly anyone who did not marvel at its design, he says. 'It got the Tatas the spotlight and the admiration of the cognoscenti of vehicle designers,' he points out.

Ratan's bold vision with the Nano promised to reshape personal transportation, just as Henry Ford's Model T had done in the first two decades of the twentieth century. 'I will build a motor car for the great multitude … constructed of the best materials … so low in price that no man making a good salary will be unable to own one,' Ford had once said.

Ratan, however, went a step ahead and showed the way, not only to India, but also to the world, to make a car affordable to even a person drawing a not-so-good salary. In 2008 the *Financial Times* wrote, 'The project has led some to dub the Tata Group's chairman as a latter-day Henry Ford.' They may have been more accurate in their assessment than many others.